



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

January 28, 2025

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by Mayor Daniel Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Christy Davis, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: none.

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, Director of Parks and Recreation Kelli Hoover, Chief Equity Officer John Willis, Police Chief Elmer Hitt, and City Engineer Troy White.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood seconded by Councilmember Robinson to adopt the agenda. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

SPECIAL BUSINESS:

A. Amendment to Public Hearing Rules for Citizen Comment

Recommendation: *Approve the amendment to public hearing rules for citizen comment, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded for discussion by Councilmember Wood to approve the amendment to public hearing rules for citizen comment, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS: none.

PUBLIC HEARINGS:

A. JAG Grant Public Hearing

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to open the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

No comments were offered during the hearing.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to close the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

A. Minutes of the January 14, 2025 regular meeting of the Jackson City Council

B. Alley Vacation Petition

Receipt of petition to vacate a public alley located in the 1200 Block of Deyo Street and referral to the City Attorney to verify its legality and Planning Commission for review and recommendation.

C. AR Write Off

Approve annual write-off recommendations from the City Attorney and Finance Department

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the consent calendar. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS:

A. East Side Economic Development Update

City Manager Jonathan Greene provided Council with an update on the East Side Economic Development plans.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. JAG Grant Memorandum of Understanding

Recommendation: *Authorize the City Manager to sign the Memorandum of Understanding*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to authorize the City Manager to sign the Memorandum of Understanding for the JAG Grant. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. Budget Amendment for JAG Grant Funds

Recommendation: *Adopt the resolution to amend the 24/25 fiscal year budget.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to adopt the resolution to amend the 24/25 fiscal year budget for JAG. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Change Order 1 to the Hazardous Tree Removal Program contract with Top Notch Tree Care, LLC

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 1 to the Hazardous Tree Removal Program contract with Top Notch Tree Care, LLC in the increased amount of \$22,850.00 to remove trees for federally funded projects that will commence construction after seasonal limitations are in place and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to approve Change Order 1 to the Hazardous Tree Removal Program contract with Top Notch Tree Care, LLC in the increased amount of \$22,850.00 to remove trees for federally funded projects that will commence construction after seasonal limitations are in place and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. Amendment to the Parking Agreement for 113 W. Michigan Avenue transfer to Southern Michigan Bank & Trust

Recommendation: *Approve an amendment to the Parking Permit Purchase Agreement for the property at 113 W. Michigan Avenue to transfer and assign rights and obligations to the new owner, Southern Michigan Bank & Trust, and authorize the City Manager execute amendment.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve an amendment to the Parking Permit Purchase Agreement for the property at 113 W. Michigan Avenue to transfer and assign rights and obligations to the new owner, Southern Michigan Bank & Trust, and authorize the City Manager execute amendment. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. Adopt a Public Participation Plan for Recertification as a Redevelopment Ready Community through the Michigan Economic Development Corporation

Recommendation: *Adopt a Public Participation Plan for recertification as a Redevelopment Ready Community through the Michigan Economic Development Corporation.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to adopt a Public Participation Plan for recertification as a Redevelopment Ready Community through the Michigan Economic Development Corporation. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

F. Budget Amendment for MSHDA MICH Grant

Recommendation: *Approve an amendment to the 2024-2025 City of Jackson budget to reflect a revenue increase of \$880,000 and an expenditure increase of \$880,000, both related to the City of Jackson MICH grant award from the Michigan State Housing Development Authority (MSHDA), adopt the accompanying budget resolution, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute any/all related documents.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to approve an amendment to the 2024-2025 City of Jackson budget to reflect a revenue increase of \$880,000 and an expenditure increase of \$880,000, both related to the City of Jackson MICH grant award from the Michigan State Housing Development Authority, adopt the accompanying budget resolution, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute any/all related documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

G. Budget Amendment for MSHDA MI-Hope Grant

Recommendation: *Approve an amendment to the 2024-2025 City of Jackson budget to reflect a revenue increase of \$250,000 and an expenditure increase of \$250,000, both related to the City of Jackson MI-HOPE grant award from the Michigan State Housing Development Authority (MSHDA), adopt the accompanying budget resolution, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute any/all related documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve an amendment to the 2024-2025 City of Jackson budget to reflect a revenue increase of \$250,000 and an expenditure increase of \$250,000, both related to the City of Jackson MI-HOPE grant award from the Michigan State Housing Development Authority, adopt the accompanying budget resolution, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute any related documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

H. Capital Improvements Plan for the City of Jackson

Recommendation: *Adopt the 2025-2029 Capital Improvements Plan for the City of Jackson, as part of the recertification package for the MEDC's Redevelopment Ready Communities designation.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to adopt the 2025-2029 Capital Improvements Plan for the City of Jackson, as part of the recertification package for the MEDC's Redevelopment Ready Communities designation. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER'S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave all offered comments.

MANAGER'S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene did not offer comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 7:48 p.m.